

Mission Strategy 2025–28

Agreed priorities of the Circuit Leadership Team

The Circuit Leadership Team has met several times to consider a mission strategy, and propose the following.

CIRCUIT MISSION STATEMENT

‘The London Forest Methodist Circuit is committed to furthering God’s kingdom by: enabling and supporting local churches in the growth of their discipleship and mission; resourcing local churches under the power of the Holy Spirit to function as effective centres for worship, witness and community wellbeing; and seeking new developments in mission between and beyond the existing churches.’

Five priorities

Recommended by the Circuit Leadership Team, in no particular order.

1 Communications

AIM	To develop a circuit communications strategy/network, to promote a greater sense of circuit identity, better sharing of information, ideas and resources between churches; and enable better sharing of circuit decisions and activities across the churches.
HOW	Recruitment of a communications officer (paid/volunteer) to: develop and maintain the circuit website and social media platforms, develop and promote new communications tools, be the first contact point for information dissemination, resource local churches accordingly.
NEXT STEPS	CLT to scope the role, consider grant application to the District Advance Fund, bring back proposals to the July circuit meeting.

2 Debden Trinity

AIM	To develop the church’s outreach in ways that ensure the long-term viability of the church, clarify its role and mission in the community, and enable a property strategy.
HOW	To scope the role of a Children & Families Work Pioneer and seek grant funding from Methodist sources including NPNP.
NEXT STEPS	Reconstitute the Trinity Focus Group with Dallion Roye & Flo Corbett as circuit representatives, propose a modified Memorandum of Understanding between Trinity, Loughton and the circuit; bring progress report to the September circuit meeting.

3 Youth & young adults

AIM	Supporting and developing faith and social networks among children and young adults.
HOW	Setting up a circuit youth group/network for the 13–20 age range, and for the 20–35 age range. To be resourced by a member of circuit staff and/or volunteers.
NEXT STEPS	Identify prospective leaders, set up a steering group, bring progress report to the July circuit meeting.

4 Social events

AIM	Promote greater sense of circuit identity, fellowship and learning.
HOW	Regular social and educational/spiritual events such as trips to places of interest, alongside some celebratory events.
NEXT STEPS	Circuit staff to devise annually a plan for each connexional year including such events, with the commitment to holding at least two each year. To consider the feasibility of one visit and one event before the end of August.

5 Explore Wanstead and North Chingford usage

AIM	To explore the possibilities for mission at North Chingford and Wanstead using the existing premises. For a limited period.
HOW	Develop the North Chingford premises for FCENS and other community usage; develop a plan for the use of the Wanstead premises as a venue for arts/performance with a missional element.
NEXT STEPS	The FCENS proposal is already being worked on. Progress reports to be brought to each circuit meeting for monitoring and decisions.